

SKILLS GUIDE



A strong proficiency in computer applications and graphic design software.



Effective communication skills for dealing with clients, agencies, and potential employers.



A high level of creativity and talent to produce eye-catching work and generate new ideas.



Good commercial awareness for negotiating fees with clients and working in a competitive market.



Flexibility to take on different kinds of work when opportunities in a particular area become scarce.



The ability to follow a client's brief and accurately produce complex technical illustrations.



BOOK OR MAGAZINE ILLUSTRATOR

Draws images that accompany articles in magazines, or which illustrate and enliven text in books.



MEDICAL OR TECHNICAL ILLUSTRATOR

Produces images of medical conditions and procedures that help people understand complex information in textbooks, instruction manuals, or sales brochures.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **GRAPHIC DESIGNER** *see pp. 22–23*
- ▶ **GAME DEVELOPER** *see pp. 130–131*
- ▶ **ANIMATOR** Draws multiple images by hand, or uses software, to animate a character or object on screen. An animator may produce work for cartoon films, commercials, computer games, websites, and other media.
- ▶ **ART DIRECTOR** Leads and directs a team responsible for the design of visual concepts and images in creative industries, such as advertising, publishing, film and TV, or web design.
- ▶ **STORYBOARD ARTIST** Draws sequences of illustrations that show the key points in a story, which are then used as a basis for filming.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Art • Drawing and painting • Graphic design • English • Sciences • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Illustrators need good training and a strong portfolio of creative work, or a degree in art, illustration, or graphics.



LIFESTYLE Freelance illustrators can set their own working hours; those employed by companies work regular office hours.



LOCATION Although illustrators can work at home or in a studio, they may need to visit a client's office to discuss briefs and promote their work.



THE REALITIES Paid commissions may be sporadic for freelance illustrators, so many have a second job to maintain a regular income.